



CALICUT UNIVERSITY – FOUR-YEAR UNDERGRADUATE PROGRAMME (CU-FYUGP)

**GENERAL FOUNDATION COURSES
SKILL ENHANCEMENT COURSE (SEC)**

Programme	GENERAL FOUNDATION COURSES				
Course Code	ENG4FS111(3)				
Course Title	CONTEMPORARY LANGUAGE SKILLS FOR COMMERCE AND MANAGEMENT				
Type of Course	SKILL ENHANCEMENT COURSE (SEC)- COMMERCE AND MANAGEMENT				
Semester	4				
Academic Level	100-199				
Course Details	Credit	Lecture per week	Tutorial per week	Practical per week	Total Hours
	3	2	-	2	60
Pre-requisites	Basic English language comprehension skills.				
Course Summary	The Course focuses on the skills required to equip learners to become confident and effective in business and managerial communication. The course supports the learner to identify key points and critically evaluate information presented in lectures, presentations, and various audio & video formats, developing the effectiveness of communication, become competent in their field, excel in collaborating fruitfully with others and adapt to different job environments.				

Course Outcomes (CO):

CO	CO Statement	Cognitive Level*	Knowledge Category#	Evaluation Tools used
CO1	Develop soft skills to create effective presentations, incorporating technological tools for commerce and management.	C	P	Seminar Presentation/ Report/ create journals, adds etc in LMS
CO2	Develop essential grammatical acumen and proficiency in English Language.	C	P	Exam
CO3	Development of language skills for effective teamwork and group discussions.	C, Ap	M	Role-play/ Debates/ GD
CO4	Understand and analyse the structure of research articles to excel in writing & leadership skills.	U, An	C	Assignments/ Viva-Voce
CO5	Identify and apply general terms and vocabulary commonly used in business and management scenarios.	R, Ap	C, P	Exam/Report
CO6	Discover critical ethical aspects related to the development of research attitude.	Ap	M, F	Case study/ Group/Pair activities
* - Remember (R), Understand (U), Apply (Ap), Analyse (An), Evaluate (E), Create (C) # - Factual Knowledge(F) Conceptual Knowledge (C) Procedural Knowledge (P) Metacognitive Knowledge (M)				

Detailed Syllabus:

Module	Unit	Content	Hours (60)	Marks (50)
I		Four Skills of Communication to Enhance Critical Skills	8	15
		Skill: To enhance the critical and analytical skills of the learners by focusing on the four skills of communication- Listening, Speaking, Reading and Writing		
	1	10 Ways to Improve Your Listening Skills- Jennifer Herrity https://www.indeed.com/career-advice/career-development/how-to-improve-listening-skills	2	
	2	Excerpts from <i>Public Speaking for Success</i> - Dale Carnegie https://www.shortform.com/pdf/public-speaking-for-success-pdf-dale-carnegie	2	
	3	Crucial Reading Skills: Defined with Improvement Strategies- https://in.indeed.com/career-advice/career-development/reading-skills	2	
	4	7 Ways to Improve Your Writing Skills-Coursera https://www.coursera.org/in/articles/writing-skills	2	

II	Creative Challenge		8	15
	Skill: To foster innovative thinking, problem-solving abilities, and encourage the application of interdisciplinary approaches to complex issues.			
	5	Your Truth is the Most Powerful Tool- Oprah Winfrey Golden Globe Prize Acceptance Speech- Cecil B. Demille https://goldenglobes.com/articles/your-truth-is-the-most-powerful-tool-oprahs-globes-speech-in-full/	2	
	6	Creativity and Commerce: The Battle and the Balance’ - https://youtu.be/NDiroGZRwE4?si=kDCjzgw_iKbarIcO	2	
	7	My Life: A Name Trimmed With Colored Ribbons- Lyn Hejinian	2	
	8	Gender Equality is Not Just a Women’s Issue- https://www.fsg.org/blog/gender-equality-not-just-womens-issue/	2	

III	Competence: Learning the Art of Win-Win		7	10
	Skill: To focus on developing negotiation skills, collaborative strategies, and conflict resolution techniques to achieve mutually beneficial outcomes.			
	9	How I Built This with Guy Raz - The True Story of Instagram https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hRzoanUMtIw	1	
	10	6 Negotiation Skills All Professionals Can Benefit From- Kelsey Miller https://online.hbs.edu/blog/post/negotiation-skills	2	
	11	7 Steps to Conflict Resolution (Without the Dread) https://climb.pcc.edu/blog/7-steps-to-conflict-resolution-without-the-dread	2	
	12	Economic History Of Kerala From 1800 To 1947 Ad Part I : Malabar- B. A. Prakash (Pages 4-7) http://keralaeconomy.com/admin/pdfs/ECONOMIC.pdf	2	
IV	Collaboration Challenge		7	10
	Skill: To emphasize and develop skills in building teamwork, effective communication, and cooperative problem-solving skills.			
	13	Teamwork can make a Dream work https://youtu.be/6fbE52YDEjU?si=zbDiNuEsZP7C-MwJ	1	
	14	7 Problem-Solving Skills That Can Help You Be a More Successful Manager https://www.coursera.org/articles/problem-solving-skills	2	
	15	Improving Group Dynamics- https://www.mindtools.com/ad3z8yv/improving-group-dynamics	2	
	16	Teamwork Is Hard Work. Here's How to Build The Skills To Do It Well-Ann Kowal Smith https://www.forbes.com/sites/annkowalsmith/2023/04/25/teamwork-is-hard-work-heres-how-to-build-the-skills-to-do-it-well/	2	

	V	Practicum	30	
		Module I: 1. Whispering a message down a line of learners. For a commerce twist, start with a complex business concept or scenario whispered to the first learner. After it's passed down the line, have the last learner explain it out loud. Discuss the discrepancies and emphasize the importance of active listening. 2. Learners develop a compelling “elevator pitch” for a new product, business idea, or service within a short time limit (typically 30-60 seconds). They then present their pitch to the class or a small group, aiming to grab attention and spark interest (with a twist - learners can pitch their ideas to a “potential investor”; played by another learner, focusing on persuasion and highlighting the value proposition). 3. The activity highlights the importance of strong supply chain management and risk mitigation strategies for e-commerce businesses. Understanding potential vulnerabilities, like theft or logistical errors, is crucial to ensure smooth operations and customer satisfaction and explore what steps they could take to minimize the risk of similar incidents in the future (e.g., implementing real-time tracking, strengthening security measures at warehouses). 4. A major retailer accidentally leaks its Black Friday deals early, causing chaos and long lines. Instead of whispering “Black Friday,” each person whispers a different holiday (e.g., Christmas, Valentine's Day). 5. Assign learners to listen to a business-related podcast episode and write a critical summary analyzing the key points, arguments, and their implications for the business world. 6. Organize a debate on a current business issue, encouraging learners to research, formulate arguments, and critically engage with opposing views. 7. Have learners present a business case study analysis, focusing on the critical evaluation of the situation, decisions made, and outcomes. 8. Implement peer review sessions where learners critique each other's written work, providing constructive feedback on the analysis, coherence, and persuasiveness of arguments.	8	

		Module II: 1. Preparing Questionnaires: Learn about different question types (multiple choice, open-ended, Likert scale), target audience identification and pilot testing. 2. Practice structuring reports and assignments with introductions, conclusions, and visuals like charts and graphs. 3. Interdisciplinary Case Studies: Analyze complex business cases from multiple perspectives (e.g., finance, marketing, ethics) to encourage innovative problem-solving. 4. Design Thinking Workshops: Engage in hands-on sessions applying design thinking principles to develop creative solutions for business challenges. 5. Cross-disciplinary Debates: Organize debates on contemporary business issues integrating diverse viewpoints from economics, psychology, and technology. 6. Innovation Challenges: Conduct competitions where teams propose innovative business ideas, emphasizing feasibility and market potential. 7. Brainstorming Sessions: Facilitate structured brainstorming sessions to generate and evaluate unconventional solutions to industry-specific problems. 8. Simulation Games: Participate in business simulations (e.g., market simulations, supply chain management) to apply interdisciplinary knowledge in realistic scenarios.	8	
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		Module III: 1. Marketing Campaign for a New Restaurant - A local, family-friendly pizzeria looking to expand its customer base and attract young professionals. Develop a targeted social media campaign and suggest creative menu additions to appeal to the new demographic. 2. Divide learners into pairs and assign roles like salesperson and client, manager and employee, or negotiators representing different companies. Provide a scenario related to a business situation (e.g., product demo, contract negotiation, resolving customer complaint). Learners act out the scenario, focusing on clear communication, appropriate language, and persuasive techniques. (switch roles after each scenario, allowing the learners to experience different communication styles and perspectives) 3. Team-Based Case Study Analysis: Collaboratively analyze business cases, emphasizing effective communication, role clarity, and cooperative problem-solving. 4. Cross-functional Project Teams: Form teams with diverse expertise to tackle real-world business challenges, fostering teamwork and integrated problem-solving. 5. Mock Negotiation Exercises: Role-play negotiation scenarios to enhance communication, collaboration, and conflict resolution skills in business contexts. 6. Interactive Workshops on Decision Making: Engage in workshops exploring decision-making frameworks, promoting teamwork and consensus-building skills. 7. Problem-Solving Workshops: Participate in workshops where teams apply structured problem-solving methods to address business problems collaboratively. 8. Business Simulation Games: Play simulations requiring teams to manage virtual companies, fostering teamwork, communication, and strategic decision-making skills.	7	
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		Module IV 1. Role-Playing Scenarios: Engage in simulated business scenarios to practice teamwork, communication, and collaborative problem-solving under pressure. 2. Cross-Functional Team Projects: Collaborate in teams composed of diverse skills to tackle complex business challenges, emphasizing effective communication and integrated problem-solving. 3. Group Presentations with Peer Evaluation: Deliver presentations as teams on industry topics, incorporating peer feedback to refine communication and teamwork. 4. Conflict Resolution Workshops: Participate in structured workshops to develop strategies for resolving conflicts constructively within team settings. 5. Team-building Activities: Engage in activities such as trust falls and problem-solving challenges to strengthen team dynamics and cooperation. 6. Case Study Debates: Debate differing solutions to business cases to enhance critical thinking, negotiation skills, and teamwork. 7. Virtual Team Projects: Collaborate remotely on projects using digital tools, focusing on effective virtual communication and teamwork. 8. Community Service Projects: Undertake projects benefiting the community to foster teamwork, communication, and problem-solving while making a positive impact.	7	
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Note: Note: The course is divided into five modules, with four having 16 fixed units and one open ended module with a variable number of units. There are total 30 transaction hours for the fixed modules and 30 hours for the open ended one. Internal assessments (25 marks) as split between the open-ended module (15 Marks) and the fixed modules (10 Marks). The final exam, however, covers only the 16 units from the fixed modules.

Suggested Reading:

1. Coughter, Peter. *The Art of the Pitch: Persuasion and Presentation Skills that Win Business*. Palgrave Macmillan, 2012.
2. Budhale, Prajeet. *The Golden Book of Business Presentation Skills*. Bloomsbury, 2021
3. Lightheart, Andrew (2016) *Presentation Now: Prepare a Perfect Presentation in Less than Three Hours*. Pearson, 2016
4. Bird, Malcolm. *The Complete Guide to Business and Sales Presentation*. Quarto, 1990.
5. *The Golden Book of Business Presentation Skills* by Prajeet Budhale
6. "Slide:ology: The Art and Science of Creating Great Presentations" by Nancy Duarte
7. Body language: How to read others Thoughts by their Gestures by Allen Pease

Mapping of COs with PSOs and POs:

	PSO1	PSO2	PSO3	PSO4	PSO5	PSO6	PO1	PO2	PO3	PO4	PO5	PO6	PO7
CO 1	3	-	2	-	1	-	3	1	2	1	-	2	-
CO 2	3	-	-	1	2	-	2	3	-	-	3	-	2
CO 3	-	3	2	-	1	-	-	3	1	-	1	3	-
CO 4	2	-	1	1	2	3	2	-	-	1	2	-	3
CO 5	1	3	3	2	-	1	3	2	2	3	-	-	-
CO 6	1	3	1	-	3	-	1	2	-	1	3	2	1

Correlation Levels:

Level	Correlation
-	Nil
1	Slightly / Low
2	Moderate / Medium
3	Substantial / High

Assessment Rubrics:

- Quiz /Discussion / Seminar
- Midterm Exam
- Assignments

Mapping of COs to Assessment Rubrics:

	Internal Exam	Assignment	Seminar Presentations	End Semester Examinations	Viva Voce
CO 1	✓			✓	✓
CO 2	✓			✓	✓
CO 3			✓		
CO 4	✓	✓		✓	
CO 5	✓			✓	
CO 6		✓	✓		